

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2

PAPER 2 November 2021

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2021 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

The motion The hall smelled of floor polish and nerves. Chipo adjusted the card that said PROPOSITION and tried not to look at the teachers in the back row. The motion was “This house believes homework should be abolished.” She had been chosen because she was fluent, not because she believed the motion. That, her debate coach said, was the point of the game: to wear a view as if it were a blazer. The first speaker for the opposition was Farai, who farmed facts the way his father farmed maize — in straight lines. He quoted a study, then another, until the audience grew restless. Chipo’s partner whispered, “We are dead.” Chipo shook her head. She had noticed that Farai never looked at the Form Ones in the front, who actually did the homework being discussed. When her turn came, she did not begin with a definition copied from a website. She told the story of her neighbour Tinashe, who walked fourteen kilometres, fetched water, and then sat under a solar lamp that died at eight. “Homework,” she said, “is not the same burden in every house.” A teacher frowned, perhaps at the politics of it. The Form Ones leaned forward. Farai smiled a small, unwilling smile, the smile of a person who has been fairly hit. They lost, narrowly. In the corridor Farai caught up with her. “Your neighbour — is he real?” “Yes.” “Then the motion is the wrong one,” he said. “We should have debated how to make homework possible.” Chipo looked at him. The blazer of the game had slipped. For a moment they were not proposition and opposition, only two learners who had seen the same country through different windows. She went home and, instead of celebrating or sulking, wrote a letter to the school development committee about study space after dark. It was not a winning speech. It was, she thought, a more useful paragraph.

2. (a) Why was Chipo chosen to speak for the proposition? [2] (b) How does the writer suggest Farai’s speaking style has a weakness? [3] (c) What is the effect of Chipo’s story about Tinashe? [4] (d) Explain “the blazer of the game had slipped” in your own words. [3] (e) What does Chipo do after the debate, and why is it important? [4] (f) Give one word or short phrase for “farmed facts”. [4] **[20]**

3. In not more than 160 words, summarise what happens in the debate and what Chipo learns from it. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. You are late for a lesson. When you enter, you should say: **[2]**

- A) May I come in, Sir/Madam? I am sorry I am late.
- B) The other class is also late.
- C) What did I miss?
- D) It's not my fault, the bell is wrong.

5. You bump into a teacher who is carrying a pile of books. The most appropriate thing to say is: **[2]**

- A) Sorry, Sir/Madam. Let me help you with those.
- B) Move, I was here first.
- C) Those books are too many anyway.
- D) Watch where you're going!

6. You need to interrupt two teachers who are talking. You say: **[2]**

- A) Excuse me, Sir and Madam, may I interrupt for a moment?
- B) You two never stop talking.
- C) Keys!
- D) Hey, I need the key now.

7. A classmate borrows your pen and does not return it. You say: **[2]**

- A) Buy your own, beggar.
- B) I'm telling the whole school.
- C) May I have my pen back, please? I need it for the next lesson.
- D) You always steal.

8. Your friend has just failed a test and looks upset. The most appropriate comment is: **[2]**

- A) I told you you were lazy.
- B) Failure is your brand now.
- C) That paper was easy, actually.
- D) I'm sorry. We can go through it together if you want.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).